

A Star Fleet Battles™ Rule Proposal

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The storied Federation Express Company, and its FDX-type ships (R1.11), gained an impressive reputation for secure and speedy delivery of small, high-priority cargoes. But away from major systems and trade routes, the last few parsecs of delivery loops were sometimes serviced by contracted (owned by an individual, or a small company) freighters operated under private delivery agreements with Federation Express.

Designed and leased by the larger corporation, this skid provided a secure method of cargo transfer. The contractor had no access to the skid interior, which was sealed and shielded to insure its cargo was safe from unauthorized entry. The contracted freighter would simply attach the skid and then proceed to the destination, where the skid was detached; only an authorized Federation Express representative could access the contents at the point of delivery.

The skid contains an APR box, a battery and two cargo boxes. As a consequence of the special internal shielding intended to defeat transporter beams, the skid also has a single box that functions as if it were Armor (D4.12). Until this box is destroyed, the skid (excluding the attached freighter and pod, if any) cannot be boarded *via* transporter, even once the shields of the attached freighter are down (the skid could still be cut open from the outside, but the construction meant the process was rather time-consuming).

Unlike most skids with power-related systems, the APR and battery were deliberately not tied into the attached freighter's power busses. They existed solely to power the anti-tamper system (which prevented the skid from being attached to a freighter or pod if it had been detached without proper authentication), anti-transporter shielding and structural integrity field of the skid. This had the side-effect of making them unattractive (that is, uneconomical) targets for theft of just an empty skid.

The skid had no crew. It increased the freighter's BPV by three.

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